

Arthritis Support Groups in Wales

Practical NHS-backed advice on arthritis support groups near me wales.

By **Living With Arthritis UK** · Reviewed by **Louis Maxwell** (HCPC Registered Physiotherapist) · 2026-07-24 · livingwitharthritis.org.uk

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Quick Answer: Arthritis support groups in Wales are run by Versus Arthritis, NHS Health Boards, and community organisations in Cardiff, Swansea, Newport, and across rural Wales. Call the Versus Arthritis helpline (0800 5200 520) or use their online group finder. Online groups are also available if in-person attendance isn't possible.

Wales has a growing network of free arthritis support groups. Connecting with others who understand life with arthritis can be as beneficial as clinical treatment for managing pain and maintaining wellbeing.

Versus Arthritis Groups in Wales

Versus Arthritis supports self-help groups across Wales, with active groups in Cardiff, Swansea, Newport, Wrexham, and Carmarthenshire. Groups are free, led by trained volunteers with lived arthritis experience.

How to Find a Welsh Group

- Visit versusarthritis.org/support/self-help-groups
 - Call 0800 5200 520 (Mon–Fri 9am–6pm)
 - Ask your rheumatology nurse or GP for local details
 - Contact Live Well Wales (0800 100 900) for health programme information
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NHS Health Board Self-Management in Wales



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Welsh Health Boards including Aneurin Bevan, Cardiff and Vale, and Betsi Cadwaladr offer free self-management programmes for arthritis — typically 6-week courses covering pain management, exercise, and pacing. Ask your GP for a referral.

Q&A;

Question: Are there Welsh-language arthritis support groups? **Short answer:** Some NHS Health Boards provide Welsh-language self-management resources. Contact your local Health Board's patient experience team for Welsh-medium services.

Question: Do I need a diagnosis to join a support group in Wales? **Short answer:** No — most community groups welcome anyone with joint pain or arthritis symptoms with or without a formal diagnosis.

Question: I'm in rural mid-Wales — can I access support? **Short answer:** Yes — online groups and the Versus Arthritis helpline are accessible from anywhere. Some Health Boards also have outreach services for rural communities.

General information only — not medical advice. Consult your GP or specialist before changing medication or starting a new programme. Emergency: 999. NHS advice: 111. Living With Arthritis UK · livingwitharthritis.org.uk